

Mixtures



Mixture of
milk and
cereal

A mixture is created when two or more things are combined together, without bonding. A mixture can usually be easily separated back into its original parts. When atoms of different elements join, or bond, a compound is formed.



Colorado River, Arizona, USA

Suspension

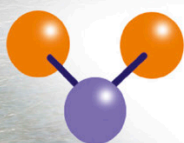
A muddy river is a type of mixture called a suspension. Small particles of soil are “suspended” in the water, making it brown and cloudy.

Alloy

Different types of metal can be melted and mixed together to make a kind of mixture called an alloy. The alloy has different properties from the original metals. This tankard is made of pewter, which is an alloy of tin and lead. Pewter is much harder than tin or lead.



Pewter
tankard



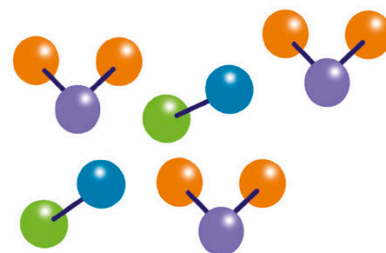
Water

+



Solute molecule

=



Solution

Solution

If you stir sugar into water, the sugar molecules spread out and fit between the water molecules, making the sugar seem to disappear. We say the sugar (a solute) has dissolved in the water (a solvent). This kind of mixture is called a solution. Seawater is a solution of water and salt. If you let seawater dry out, the salt reappears.



Salt forming
on the shore of
the Dead Sea
in Jordan.